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PORTFOLIO PACKET • SPRING 2026

Percy Holway.

3D CHARACTER & CREATURE ARTIST

SPECIALTY

Creature Pipeline • Games & Animation

EDUCATION

BFA — University of Central Florida

CONTACT

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BIO • ARTIST STATEMENT • RESUME • PORTFOLIO

— PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Bringing *Creatures* to Life in 3D.

Percy Holway is a 3D Character & Creature Artist based in Orlando, Florida, specializing in full-pipeline creature design for games and animation. He is completing a BFA in Emerging Media (Animation & Visualization) at the University of Central Florida, where he has maintained a place on the President's Honor Roll and served as Vice President of Kappa Pi International Art Honor Society.

"Topology, surface detail, and color: every design decision is benchmarked against real zoological anatomy to produce organisms that read as biologically coherent within their intended ecosystems."

His production practice spans the complete creature pipeline: high-resolution organic sculpting in ZBrush, retopology and UV layout in Autodesk Maya, PBR material authoring in Substance 3D Painter, and real-time asset integration in Unreal Engine 5. Each project is grounded in zoological reference: surface topology, scale distribution, color palette, and locomotion logic are derived from real anatomy and environmental adaptation, producing organisms that read as credible within their intended ecosystems.

His BFA thesis creature, *Aetheria*, synthesizes the anatomical logic of three distinct species: American Alligator, False-Water Cobra and Boa Imperator, and Pine Marten, into a single biologically coherent original organism. Developed across the full production pipeline and integrated into Unreal Engine 5, *Aetheria* was selected as a centerpiece of the 2026 UCF BFA thesis exhibition, where it was seen by hundreds of attendees. Percy also served as creature artist, rigger, and animator for *Mol's Morsels*, a UCF student short film, managing the hero character's complete lifecycle from initial ZBrush sculpt through final animation delivery; iterating the rig continuously in response to animation performance needs throughout production.

Beyond creature work, Percy contributed to conservation outreach as scriptwriter and concept artist for The Croc Docs' instructional video produced for Florida's Python Challenge, reaching all registered participants with guidance on humane euthanasia protocols for invasive Burmese pythons. He previously held a position with PeerKnights/Peer Mentorship at UCF, producing outreach designs for social media campaigns and digital displays across campus. He has held an active freelance practice in digital character commissions since 2022, and is an Adobe Certified Professional in Adobe After Effects (Certiport).

— AETHERIA & THE PRACTICE OF SPECULATIVE BIOLOGY

Designing *Organisms* That Could Exist.

My work is an exploration of speculative biology: the creation of creatures that sit precisely at the boundary between the alien and the familiar. My thesis project, *Aetheria*, distills this practice: a majestic apex predator developed as both a technical study in anatomy and a study in environmental reflection. I approach creature design not as fantasy, but as a production exercise in biological plausibility; asking what an organism would actually look like if the real world were given the room to diversify. *Aetheria* is a digital sculpture, but it is also a living resident of a designed ecosystem, built to provoke curiosity about the biological possibilities our planet holds.

The creature's form draws from three anatomical sources synthesized into one coherent silhouette: the structural mass and aquatic capability of the American Alligator, the serpentine neck and tail flow of the False-Water Cobra and Boa Imperator, and the elongated proportion and facial expressiveness of the Pine Marten. The result is a predator capable of immense power and sudden, explosive movement; a contradiction held together by careful attention to weight distribution, joint articulation, and locomotion logic. Its palette mirrors the ethereal tonal range of White Sands National Park at sunset: iridescent scales, soft pastels, and luminous desaturated gradients that evoke the natural world without literally depicting it. The goal was awe over fear: a deliberate response to the sense of wonder many lose as familiarity replaces curiosity.

Technically, *Aetheria* was developed through a complete production pipeline. Custom ZBrush Alphas were built to accelerate surface detailing across repeated organic structures. Retopology was engineered with deformation performance and joint behavior as primary constraints. PBR material authoring in Substance 3D Painter prioritized physical accuracy: how light settles across layered scales, how iridescence reads at various angles. Subtle facial rigging and controlled eye movement were implemented to suggest biological awareness without theatrical exaggeration, allowing the creature's presence to feel grounded.

Aetheria is not presented as a sculptural object in isolation. The design accounts for how it occupies space: how its silhouette reads at distance, how its surface interacts with ambient and directional light, how its proportions suggest behavior within an ecosystem. Rather than relying on narrative context to make it legible, the piece communicates through visual clarity and material presence; inviting the viewer to engage with it as a credible organism shaped by its environment. This is the core of my practice: creature design grounded in observation, technical execution, and the conviction that biological plausibility is itself a form of visual storytelling.

Percy Holway.

3D CHARACTER & CREATURE ARTIST

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EDUCATION

University of Central Florida

BFA Emerging Media — Animation & Visualization

Minor: Creative Writing

Expected May 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Creature Anatomy & Organic Sculpting
- Hair Cards & Grooming (GS Curve Tools / FiberShop)
- Real-Time Asset Optimization
- Retopology & UV Unwrapping
- PBR Texturing
- Character Rigging (IK/FK)
- Unreal Engine 5 Integration
- 3D & 2D Animation
- 2D Concept Art & Storyboarding
- Motion Graphics & Compositing
- Scriptwriting

SOFTWARE

ZBrush · Autodesk Maya · Substance 3D Painter · Unreal Engine 5 · After Effects · Premiere Pro · Photoshop · Illustrator · ToonBoom Harmony · Marmoset Toolbag · Blender

CERTIFICATIONS

Adobe Certified Professional
in Adobe After Effects · Certiport

AWARDS & ORGS

UCF President's Honor Roll

Fall 2023, Spring 2024

UCF Dean's List

Fall 2022, Spring 2024

VP — Kappa Pi Art Honors

Fall 2023 – Spring 2024

We In Animation (WIA)

UCF Knight Riders

FEATURED PROJECTS

Aetheria — Thesis Creature [THESIS]

Spring 2026

BFA Thesis Exhibition Piece — ZBrush · Maya · Substance 3D Painter · Unreal Engine 5

- Designed and executed a full creature pipeline as the centerpiece of my BFA thesis — organic sculpting, retopology, PBR texturing, and Unreal Engine 5 integration; displayed at the April 2026 thesis exhibition, seen by hundreds of attendees.
- Synthesized the anatomy of three real-world species — American Alligator, False-Water Cobra/Boa Imperator, and Pine Marten — into a single biologically coherent design; every proportion and surface decision benchmarked against zoological reference.
- Developed custom ZBrush Alphas to streamline surface detailing across repeated organic structures; iterated on anatomy, silhouette, and material reads through structured critique sessions throughout production.

Short Film: Mol's Morsels [COLLABORATIVE]

Spring 2026

Creature Artist, Rigger & Animator — Student Short Film Production

- Full pipeline ownership for the hero character — ZBrush sculpt, Maya retopology, Substance 3D Painter PBR texturing, IK/FK rig construction, and character animation through final delivery.
- Iterated the rig continuously in response to animation performance needs; close cross-department collaboration required precise technical communication and rapid asset iteration under production deadlines.

Instructional Video: Python Challenge — Ethical Euthanasia Guide [COLLABORATIVE]

2025 – 2026

Scriptwriter & 2D Concept Artist — The Croc Docs

- Co-wrote the production script for Florida's Python Challenge, targeting all registered participants with procedural guidance on humane euthanasia of invasive Burmese pythons.
- Created 2D concept art and visual references used throughout production to communicate key procedural steps clearly to a general audience.
- Collaborated with the production team on content accuracy, visual tone, and pacing to ensure the deliverable met educational and conservation outreach compliance standards.

Dr. Phillips Performing Arts Center Exhibition

Fall 2022

Exhibiting Artist — Public Juried Showcase

- Designed and exhibited a six-foot physical sculpture at a public showcase with 1,000+ attendees; work selected for display alongside faculty and community artists.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Character Artist · Self-Employed

2022 – Present

Orlando, FL

- Delivered custom digital character commissions for private clients — full creative lifecycle management from brief and concept development through revision cycles and final high-resolution delivery.
- Developed structured client communication and iteration workflows to maintain production timelines while incorporating multi-round feedback.
- Designed apparel graphics — including a featured T-shirt for a Florida collegiate arts organization — distributed across a student body of 60,000+.

Marketing Strategist · UCF Office of Academic Advocacy 2024 – 2025

Orlando, FL

- Produced motion graphics and Adobe Creative Suite assets supporting 5+ campus events and multi-platform social media campaigns per semester.
- Collaborated with a student team to develop targeted marketing strategies and visual content, increasing brand visibility across UCF's student body.

SPECIALTY-FOCUSED ONLINE PORTFOLIO

Curated Work Online.

Primary Portfolio URL

percypalooza.github.io/percyholway.portfolio/

Custom-built portfolio site designed and coded from scratch — visual design, layout logic, and strategic curation derived from research into dozens of professional creature and character artist portfolios at studios including ILM, Blur Studio, Weta Workshop, and Epic Games. Work is presented in a click-minimal grid from the landing page, with ArtStation-style lightbox views containing full image sets, pipeline descriptions, software used, and time-spent data per project.

Curated Works — Visual Overview



AETHERIA



ZIGMOL



ALLIGATOR GAR



HECTOR



SWAMP PREY



HAND STUDY

Site Portfolio Elements

Name & Professional Title
Prominently displayed in the hero — stylized typographic treatment and animated entry.

Clickable Grid Layout
All works accessible from the main page in a three-column masonry grid with full lightbox access.

Research-Derived Visual Design
Layout and aesthetic informed by research into professional creature artist portfolios at ILM, Blur Studio, Weta, Epic.

Downloadable PDF Resume
Linked directly from the navigation and the dedicated resume page — accessible in one click from anywhere on the site.

About Me & Hard Skills
Full bio, professional summary, software proficiency list, technical skill groups, and professional headshot.

Contact Information
Email, ArtStation, and LinkedIn displayed prominently with a services statement and contact form.

Curated Works — Pipeline Summaries

WORK	PURPOSE & HARD SKILLS	SOFTWARE	TIME
Aetheria Thesis Creature	Full creature pipeline — organic sculpting, production retopology, PBR material authoring, real-time UE5 integration; custom Alpha development. BFA thesis exhibition centerpiece, April 2026.	ZBrush, Maya, Substance 3D Painter, UE5	~14 wks
Zigmol Mol's Morsels	Hero character full pipeline for student short film — sculpt, retopology, UV, PBR texturing, IK/FK rig construction, character animation, look-dev.	ZBrush, Maya, Substance 3D Painter	~10 wks
Alligator Gar Anatomy Study	Speed sculpt → full production asset; comparative animal anatomy study, PBR texturing from albino specimen zoological reference, beauty render pipeline.	ZBrush, Substance 3D Painter, Maya	2 days
Hector Eel Creature	First character model — full creature pipeline from fang-tooth moray eel anatomical reference; organic sculpt, production retopology, PBR texturing, posed beauty render.	ZBrush, Maya, Substance 3D Painter	16 wks
Swamp Prey Independent Study	Original creature designed from semi-aquatic fauna anatomy — capybara and tufted deer reference, splayed foot morphology, modified nasal structure. Active grooming pipeline: GS Curve Tools + FiberShop, targeting UE5 and Marmoset renders.	ZBrush, Maya, GS Curve Tools, FiberShop	Active dev
Hand Study Anatomy	Écorché anatomy study — sculpt developed from skeletal and tendon architecture outward. Focus: metacarpal/phalangeal form, extensor tendon routing, knuckle deformation under directional light.	ZBrush, Maya	~2 wks